



Canada's cybersecurity crisis isn't a lack of talent — it's a lack of experience

Why the future of our digital safety hinges on building real-world, hands-on cyber skills

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The Canadian cybersecurity market is struggling to find mid-to-senior level talent with practical, hands-on experience who can hit the ground running. PHOTO: GETTY IMAGES

As cyber threats grow more sophisticated, Canada is racing to secure its digital infrastructure. From ransomware attacks on hospitals to phishing campaigns targeting critical infrastructure, the demand for cybersecurity talent has never been higher. But a new national report reveals a sobering reality: the problem isn't that Canadians aren't interested in cybersecurity — it's that we're not preparing them to actually do the work.

Financial Post

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Canadian Cybersecurity Network

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Canada's Cybersecurity Hiring Market Is Recovering. Its Talent Pipeline Is Not.



Francois Guay : Updated on August 6, 2026

Canadian Cybersecurity Jobs

An editorial analysis of the Canadian cybersecurity job market, covering 13 provinces and 2,448 open roles from March 2025 – February 2026.

TOTAL POSTINGS 2,448 Cybersecurity roles tracked across Canada	AVG. SALARY (MIN) \$90,490 Average advertised minimum (CAD)	AVG. SALARY (MAX) \$117,399 Average advertised maximum (CAD)	TOP PROVINCE 57% Ontario — 1,395 postings
MOST IN-DEMAND CERT 30.2% CCSP appears in 30.2% of postings	HYBRID WORK 36.9% The most common work arrangement	REMOTE WORK 26.4% Fully remote postings	ENTRY-LEVEL ROLES 5.4% Only 132 postings — a notable

“With the AI wave accelerating risk and opportunity at once, it’s encouraging to see growth in Canadian Cybersecurity Network job board postings: 663 in the second quarter, up 127 over the first and the strongest of our seven quarters, though some of that reflects broader collection rather than pure market growth. AI is expanding what every organization must defend, and boards are not treating security headcount as discretionary,” McMichael said.

That changes the way we should think about Canada's often discussed cybersecurity skills shortage. Some of the shortage is undoubtedly a supply problem, particularly in specialized areas where expertise is scarce. But the data raises another possibility: part of Canada's shortage may increasingly be a **pipeline design problem**. We cannot continuously demand experienced cybersecurity professionals while collectively creating too few opportunities for inexperienced professionals to become experienced.